

Cyber Security Incident Report

Reference: CB/IR/2026/0412 | Classification: Restricted

Issued by the Computer Security Incident Response Team

Executive Summary

On 11 March 2026 the Incident Response Team confirmed unauthorised access to the departmental identity provider. The intrusion was detected by anomalous authentication telemetry and contained within 6 hours of first alert.

A total of 37 user credentials were compromised across 4 regional offices. No evidence of data exfiltration beyond directory metadata has been identified at the time of writing.

The estimated financial impact is 18.4 lakh rupees, comprising incident response effort, forced credential rotation and third-party forensic support.

Scope

This report covers systems within the departmental Active Directory forest and the federated single sign-on gateway. Field office networks operating on isolated infrastructure are out of scope.

Incident Timeline

All timestamps are Indian Standard Time (UTC+05:30).

- 11 March 2026, 02:14 - Anomalous authentication volume detected.
- 11 March 2026, 02:51 - Security Operations Centre raises severity to High.
- 11 March 2026, 04:20 - Compromised service account disabled.
- 11 March 2026, 08:10 - Containment confirmed across all 4 offices.
- 12 March 2026, 11:00 - Forced password reset completed for 37 accounts.
- 14 March 2026, 17:30 - Forensic imaging of 2 domain controllers completed.

Detection

Detection originated from the authentication analytics rule AUTH-114, which flags credential stuffing patterns. Mean time to detect was 41 minutes from the first malicious authentication attempt.

Findings

Credential Exposure

37 user credentials were compromised. Of these, 5 belonged to accounts holding elevated privileges within the identity management console. All 37 accounts were subject to mandatory password rotation.

Password reuse across the departmental portal and an external vendor service was the primary contributing factor in 29 of the 37 cases.

Multi-Factor Authentication Gaps

Multi-factor authentication was enforced on only 62 percent of in-scope accounts. Every one of the 37 compromised accounts lacked a second factor.

Logging and Retention

Authentication logs were retained for 30 days against a policy requirement of 180 days, limiting retrospective analysis of the intrusion.

Recommendations

- Enforce multi-factor authentication on 100 percent of privileged accounts within 30 days.
- Extend authentication log retention to 180 days to meet policy.
- Deploy credential stuffing detection at the federation gateway.
- Complete a password hygiene audit across all 4 regional offices.
- Review vendor access agreements covering shared identity material.

Conclusion

The incident was contained without confirmed data loss, but the absence of multi-factor authentication on affected accounts represents a systemic control weakness. Implementation of the recommendations above is assessed as high priority.

Approved by the Chief Information Security Officer on 20 March 2026.